

EG Energy, Climate & Resources, United Kingdom: Great Britain likely to narrowly miss clean power pledge

送信者: EG Energy, Climate & Resources 受信日時: 2026-07-27 18:51

[【メール原文】](#)

Energy, Climate & Resources, United Kingdom

27 Jul 2026 05:49 EDT

Great Britain likely to narrowly miss clean power pledge

Short-term trajectory:

Long-term trajectory:

* Prime Minister Andy Burnham will likely retain Labour's pledge for England, Scotland, and Wales to generate at least 95% of electricity from clean sources by 2030, with roughly 40% odds of delivering on this commitment by the deadline.

* The government's priority 2030 pipeline provides a credible pathway, but connecting new projects to the grid and navigating interconnector constraints create additional operational risks.

* Burnham will likely preserve core delivery mechanisms—Contracts for Difference (CfD) auctions, Great British Energy, and grid reform—but his push for devolution, domestic supply chains, and greater public ownership will have mixed effects on hitting the target.

Burnham will likely keep pledge to generate 95% of electricity from clean sources by 2030. The target applies to Great Britain (England, Scotland, and Wales) rather than the entire UK, because Northern Ireland is integrated into the Irish power market. However, Burnham will likely reframe the goal around lower bills, public control, and regional reindustrialization rather than climate leadership. The target fits too closely with his political agenda—support for domestic industry, stronger public services, and lower exposure to external shocks—for him to abandon it. Eurasia Group puts the odds of meeting the formal target at about 40%. A narrow miss followed by delivery in the early 2030s is the modal outcome.

New government inherits program with real momentum and credible, if fragile, path to delivery. The official plan targets 43-50 gigawatts (GW) of offshore wind, 27-29 GW of onshore wind, 45-47 GW of solar, and 23-27 GW of batteries, supported by 80 critical transmission projects and related infrastructure. Applying plausible follow-through rates to the grid manager National Energy System Operator's (NESO) 132 GW Phase 1 pipeline suggests installed capacity can reach government targets for solar and storage by 2030, though wind is likely to fall short. However, inclusion in the Phase 1

pipeline does not guarantee an executable connection offer or commissioning by 2030. The connections overhaul remains complex, and not all projects initially assessed under the process will advance to firm grid-connection approvals.

Further delays in the pipeline across technologies would compound the shortfall and make it harder for the government to meet the system wide 95% generation target. The greater risk is that delays across generation, transmission, connections, and flexibility could compound, leaving NESO unable to integrate enough clean power while maintaining a stable and reliable electricity system. Rapid growth in distribution-connected solar, wind, battery, and flexible-demand installations will require better visibility, forecasting, and coordination between NESO and local distribution networks. If operational systems lag capacity deployment, NESO may need to run more gas-fired generation than expected to keep the grid balanced and stable, even if annual clean output appears sufficient.

Burnham is unlikely to weaken the headline target in the near term. Such a move would expose Labour to attacks from the Green Party, without reliably winning back Reform UK voters. It would also undermine an investment pipeline that supports broad-based growth beyond London. Clean power also reinforces Labour's economic message through state coordination, skilled industrial jobs, and lower reliance on imported gas. His government will therefore very likely preserve CfD auctions, grid reform, and Great British Energy, while placing greater emphasis on manufacturing content, apprenticeships, and the regional distribution of investment.

The main policy shift will likely center on devolving more energy authority to combined authorities and local governments. Burnham has pledged regional public control over essential services, including energy, and wants the new regional branch of Downing Street known as Number 10 North to lead utility reform and reindustrialization. In practice, that likely means regional co-investment vehicles, broader local energy planning, and stronger community benefit frameworks. These measures could strengthen support for onshore wind, solar, and grid infrastructure while accelerating the adoption of distributed generation. However, new regional ownership structures and deeper devolution would probably make only an incremental contribution to the national target before 2030.

Burnham's industrial policy presents a more immediate, but manageable, risk. Preferences for UK-produced steel, turbines, cables, and other equipment would support domestic employment, but they cannot quickly resolve manufacturing bottlenecks. Rather than rigid local-content quotas, Burnham is more likely to strengthen social value and domestic supply-chain criteria in public procurement, alongside conditions on public finance and incentives for UK-based manufacturing, jobs, and apprenticeships. Those measures could modestly slow procurement but are unlikely to determine whether the target is met.

Greater public ownership will have similarly mixed effects. Additional public equity could unlock projects and better align clean power spending with regional development, but broad nationalization of networks or suppliers would prove fiscally costly and disruptive. Burnham is more likely to pursue targeted public co-investment, principally through an expanded role for Great British Energy, greater state coordination of investment and delivery, and expanded municipal participation.

More consequential will be the availability of cross-border flexibility. Restrictions on interconnector trading could limit Great Britain's ability to import and export electricity efficiently. Re-entry into the EU internal electricity market would improve cross-border electricity trading and give grid operators more tools to balance supply and demand across borders, but the timing and terms remain uncertain.

Without more efficient interconnector trading, NESO may need to retain additional domestic gas generation as insurance.

EG Energy, Climate & Resources

ecr@eurasiagroup.net

EG Europe

europe@eurasiagroup.net

Conor Frydenborg

Associate, Energy & Resources

+1 202.540.5149

frydenborg@eurasiagroup.net

Yara Alamin

Intern, Energy & Resources

alamin.ne@eurasiagroup.net

Mujtaba Rahman

Managing Director, Europe

+44 (0) 207.553.9823

rahman@eurasiagroup.net

PDF or Print | Get the EG iOS or Android mobile Apps for content on the go

Explanation of Political Trajectories (ie, "Trajectories")

Eurasia Group's (EG) Political Trajectories are indicators of the net impact of political factors on the macro business environment in a country over specific timeframes. For each country, two Trajectories are provided, a short-term (6 months) and a long term assessment (24 months). Trajectories are assigned by Eurasia Group's country analysts through a structured qualitative process. Each Trajectory represents a net assessment, indicating how political changes in a country impact the macro business environment, defined as the economic and investment climate in the country. Once initiated, Trajectories are updated both periodically and as events warrant. Trajectories may be suspended from time to time if there is no active analyst opinion or analyst coverage, but the opinion or coverage is

expected to resume. Trajectories can be:

Positive: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a positive impact on the macro business environment

Neutral: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a neutral or negligible impact on the macro business environment

Negative: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a negative impact on the macro business environment

Disclaimers: Trajectories are solely for informational purposes and should not be relied upon as investment advice. Trajectories do not indicate asset price movements, and have no value in forecasting market prices. Trajectories are based on data and analysis we deem to be reliable; they are not guaranteed as to accuracy or completeness. The Trajectories indicate the political outlook in a single country, over time. Trajectories do not address sector-specific or city/regional political risks that are often different than the country-level outlook. Trajectories represent an analyst's net qualitative assessment of a country's political outlook. EG sales, analytic staff and products may provide analysis reflecting different opinions than those expressed by the Trajectories.

© 2026 Eurasia Group. All rights reserved. This material was produced by Eurasia Group for use by the recipient. This is intended as general background research and is not intended to constitute advice on any particular commercial investment or trade matter or issue and should not be relied upon for such purposes. It is not to be made available to any person other than the recipient. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or otherwise, without the prior consent of Eurasia Group.

X-WF-DocID wfpub_eurasia_26968_7ae447b3

[To manage your email preferences click here](#) | [To manage your research content alerts click here](#)